

Activity 1: Technology Exploration (2 points)

Digital media is shaped by a constantly changing landscape of technologies, platforms, and systems. Technical literacy does not require knowing how every technology works, but it does require being able to investigate an unfamiliar technology and develop a meaningful understanding of it.

For this activity, choose one contemporary digital technology that interests you and investigate how it works, what information it uses, and why it exists.

Write a short (1-2 page) explainer about your chosen technology that answers the following questions:

1. **What does it do?** - Briefly explain the technology and its primary function.
2. **What kind of information does it use?** - Identify the important data, inputs, signals, or other information your technology receives, produces, or processes.
3. **What problem does it solve?** - Explain why the technology exists and what problem it addresses.
4. **What limitations or concerns does it introduce?** - Identify one meaningful limitation or concern regarding the technology. It can be anything (technical, social, ethical, accessibility, privacy, security, etc)

Use your own words and support your explanation with credible research sources.
Technical diagrams or images may be included where they help explain the technology.

Submission

Please upload using the .pdf format on D2L before the start of next class.

Marking

Technical Understanding (0.75%) - Accurately explains what the technology does and demonstrates understanding beyond surface level definition.

Data&Information (0.50%) - Meaningfully identifies the information/data involved and connects it to how the technology operates

Critical Analysis (0.50%) - Explains the problem being addressed and identifies meaningful limitations or concerns.

Research (0.25%) - Uses credible sources and appropriately acknowledges external information.